

DIMITRIS ZOPOUNIDIS

PhD Candidate | Business Analytics, Artificial Intelligence & Data-Driven Strategic Decision Intelligence

Researcher at the Data Science Laboratory – DS Lab, Technical University of Crete

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ACADEMIC PROFILE

Dimitris Zopounidis is a PhD Candidate at the **Data Science Laboratory – DS Lab** of the Technical University of Crete and a researcher specializing in Business Analytics, Artificial Intelligence (AI), Data Science, and Data-Driven Strategic Decision Intelligence. He is also affiliated with the Business Administration Sector of the Department of Economics at Aristotle University of Thessaloniki (AUTH) and the Fintech & Strategic Artificial Intelligence (FTSAI) Laboratory at the University of Macedonia.

His work focuses on the use of analytics and data-driven approaches to support strategic decision-making, governance, sustainability, and organizational transformation.

Combining academic research with real-world applications, he is actively involved in large-scale strategic projects across the banking, tourism, hospitality, and aviation sectors. He serves as Researcher on strategic initiatives developed in collaboration with **Alpha Bank**, including large-scale studies supporting strategic intelligence, economic development, data-driven decision-making, and evidence-based policymaking.

As Founder and Head of Research of the **Crete Aviation Observatory (CAO)**, one of Greece's leading independent aviation research initiatives, he leads empirical research on aviation analytics, sustainability, passenger behavior, and tourism-air transport dynamics. Through his academic, research, and industry engagements, he contributes to the transformation of data into actionable insights that support strategy development, organizational performance, and evidence-based decision-making.

His research interests include Business Analytics, Artificial Intelligence, Strategic Intelligence, AI governance, AI risk management, sustainability assessment, aviation analytics, banking research, financial analytics and data-driven decision-making.

EDUCATION

October 2025 – October 2028

PhD Candidate, Data Science Laboratory – DS Lab
School of Production Engineering and Management
Technical University of Crete, Chania, Greece

March 2024 – June 2025

MSc in Business Analytics and Data Science
Department of Business Administration
University of Macedonia, Thessaloniki, Greece

September 2019 – June 2023

BSc in Business Administration
Department of Business Administration
University of Macedonia, Thessaloniki, Greece

RESEARCH & PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Technical University of Crete – Data Science Laboratory (DS Lab)

Researcher and PhD Candidate | Nov 2023–Present

Alpha Bank

Researcher | May 2026–Present

Data-Driven Strategic Intelligence and Data-to-Decision Analytics Study

Large-scale strategic initiative supporting economic development, strategic intelligence, evidence-based decision-making, and policymaking for pathway to growth

Artificial Intelligence Risk Management Researcher | Apr 2026–Present

Development of AI Risk Management Methodologies aligned with the EU AI Act and responsible AI governance practices.

Crete Aviation Observatory (CAO)

Founder & Head of Research | Nov 2021–Present

Independent research initiative focused on aviation analytics, sustainability, and air transport development.

Crete Tourism Observatory

Coordinator, Researcher & Data Analyst | Aug 2020–Present

Supporting tourism intelligence, data analysis, and evidence-based decision-making for tourism stakeholders.

SeaCrete Hotels

Airport & Aviation Data Analyst | Aug 2025–Present

Hania Hotels Association

Airport & Aviation Data Analyst | Sep 2025–Present

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Technical University of Crete

Teaching Assistant, Master of Business Administration (MBA) Program | May 2026–Present

CIHEAM MAICH

Teaching Assistant, Financial Management Laboratory | March 2025–Present

SCIENTIFIC COMMUNICATION & KNOWLEDGE DISSEMINATION

aviationlife.gr

Founder & Editor-in-Chief | Dec 2020–Present

Air Letter Magazine – Hellenic Aviation Society

Editorial and Content Officer | Sep 2022–Present

PROFESSIONAL MEMBERSHIPS

Financial Engineering & Banking Society (FEBS)

Member | Sep 2020–Present

EUROPEAN RESEARCH PROJECTS

Sust-HEIn (University of Macedonia)

Researcher / Collaborator

AquaSphere (Technical University of Crete)

Researcher / Data Analytics Lead

BOOKS

Artificial Intelligence and Applications in Management

Constantin Zopounidis, Dimitris Zopounidis, Angelos Kostis.
Barbounakis Publications, 2024.

HONORS AND AWARDS

2026 – Award of Excellence (3rd Place), SkyImpact Challenge

Heraklion International Airport, Crete

Recognised among the **top three teams** in the SkyImpact Challenge for an innovative proposal supporting the future development of the New Heraklion International Airport.

PRESENTATIONS AT CONFERENCES & WORKSHOPS

15th National Conference of the Financial Engineering and Banking Society (FEBS)

“Evaluating the ESG Efficiency of Global Airlines: A DEA-Based Approach”

National and Kapodistrian University of Athens (NKUA), Athens, Greece, 18–19 December 2025

7th Hellenic Aviation Society Conference

“An Empirical Analysis of the Relationship Between Corporate Financial Performance and ESG Factors in the Airline Sector”

Sofitel Athens Airport Hotel, Athens, Greece, 5–6 June 2025

14th National Conference of the Financial Engineering and Banking Society (FEBS)

“An Empirical Analysis of the Relationship Between Corporate Financial Performance and ESG Factors in the Airline Sector”

Athens University of Economics and Business, Athens, Greece, 19–20 December 2024

12th National Conference of the Financial Engineering and Banking Society (FEBS)

“Financial Cyber Risk Analysis: The Case of the Aviation Industry II”

University of West Attica, Athens, Greece, 19–20 December 2022

11th National Conference of the Financial Engineering and Banking Society (FEBS)

“Financial Cyber Risk Analysis: The Case of the Aviation Industry I”

American College of Greece, Athens, Greece, 20–21 December 2021